

Cat Baby Safety Newborn Arrival — Action Checklist

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DESENSITIZE YOUR CAT TO BABY SENSES

- ☐ **Desensitize Your Cat to Baby Senses:** Borrow a used baby blanket or onesie from a friend with an infant and place it near your cat's feeding area so your cat learns to associate the baby smell with positive experiences like food.
- ☐ **Desensitize Your Cat to Baby Senses:** Start using the exact baby shampoo and lotion you plan to use on your newborn, then let your cat smell you afterward to build positive associations with baby-related scents before the baby arrives.
- ☐ **Desensitize Your Cat to Baby Senses:** Play recordings of baby crying at very low volume during feeding times starting five weeks before your due date, then gradually increase the volume over two weeks so the sound isn't shocking when the baby arrives.
- ☐ **Desensitize Your Cat to Baby Senses:** Increase the volume of baby crying recordings only during mealtimes so your cat learns to stay calm when hearing crying sounds and doesn't associate crying with the loss of your attention.

SET UP SAFE SPACES FOR EVERYONE

- ☐ **Set Up Safe Spaces for Everyone:** Set up the crib, changing table, and baby gear gradually over the third trimester rather than all at once so your cat adjusts to each new piece of furniture before the baby arrives and reduces territorial stress.
- ☐ **Set Up Safe Spaces for Everyone:** Install a baby gate at least 45 inches high on the nursery doorway before the baby arrives so your cat learns that the baby's room is completely off-limits before there's actually a baby to guard against.
- ☐ **Set Up Safe Spaces for Everyone:** Set up cat trees, wall shelves, or window perches that give your cat high ground where it can observe the baby from a distance because cats who can elevate feel in control and experience less stress.
- ☐ **Set Up Safe Spaces for Everyone:** Move the litter box, food, and water to locations the baby can never reach or disturb, and never place these resources in the nursery because they must stay completely separate from baby spaces.

SECURE THE BABY'S ENVIRONMENT

- ☐ **Secure the Baby's Environment:** Make the nursery completely inaccessible to your cat using a solid door or a 45-inch baby gate before the baby arrives because cats need to learn this room is off-limits before they have a reason to investigate.

 - ☐ **Secure the Baby's Environment:** Keep the litter box completely inaccessible to your baby at all times because cat feces can contain toxoplasmosis and young children who touch contaminated surfaces and put hands in their mouths can become seriously ill.

 - ☐ **Secure the Baby's Environment:** Verify that your baby gate or door barrier is at least 45 inches tall because standard baby gates are too low and cats can easily jump over them into spaces where they shouldn't be.

 - ☐ **Secure the Baby's Environment:** Double-check that all cat resources including the litter box, food, and water are positioned in areas the baby can never reach or disturb because a baby's curiosity combined with a cat's need for consistent resource access creates dangerous potential for contamination.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.